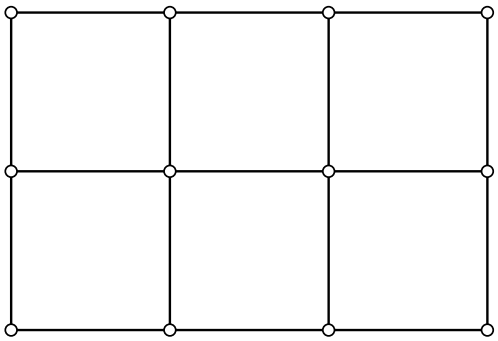
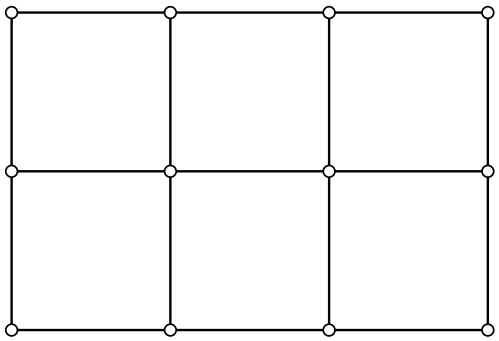
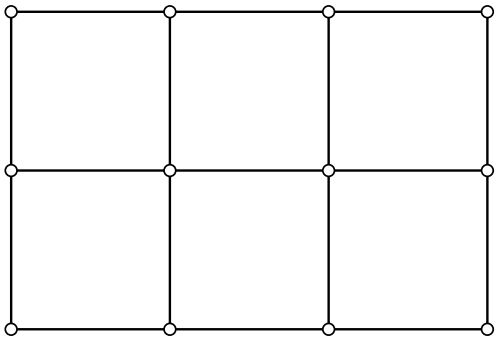
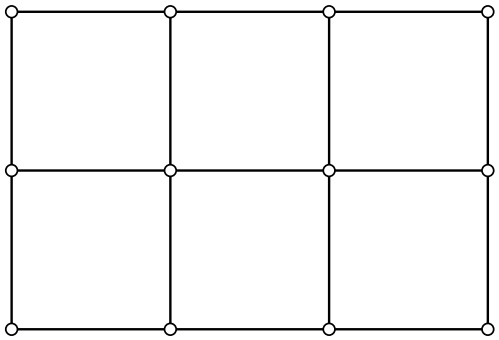
Problem 6: Find the fewest braces that make your 2-by-3 frame hold its shape. Find several designs using that many braces.

Fewest braces: _____

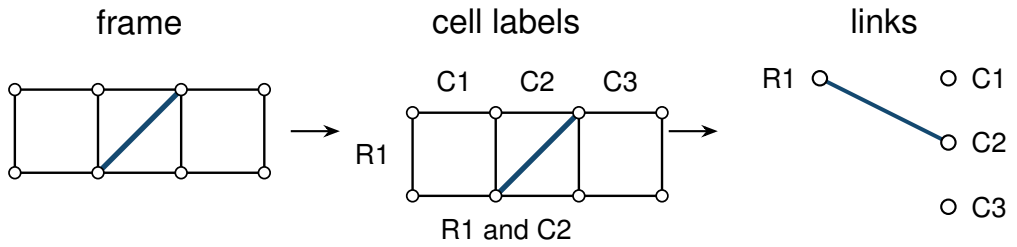




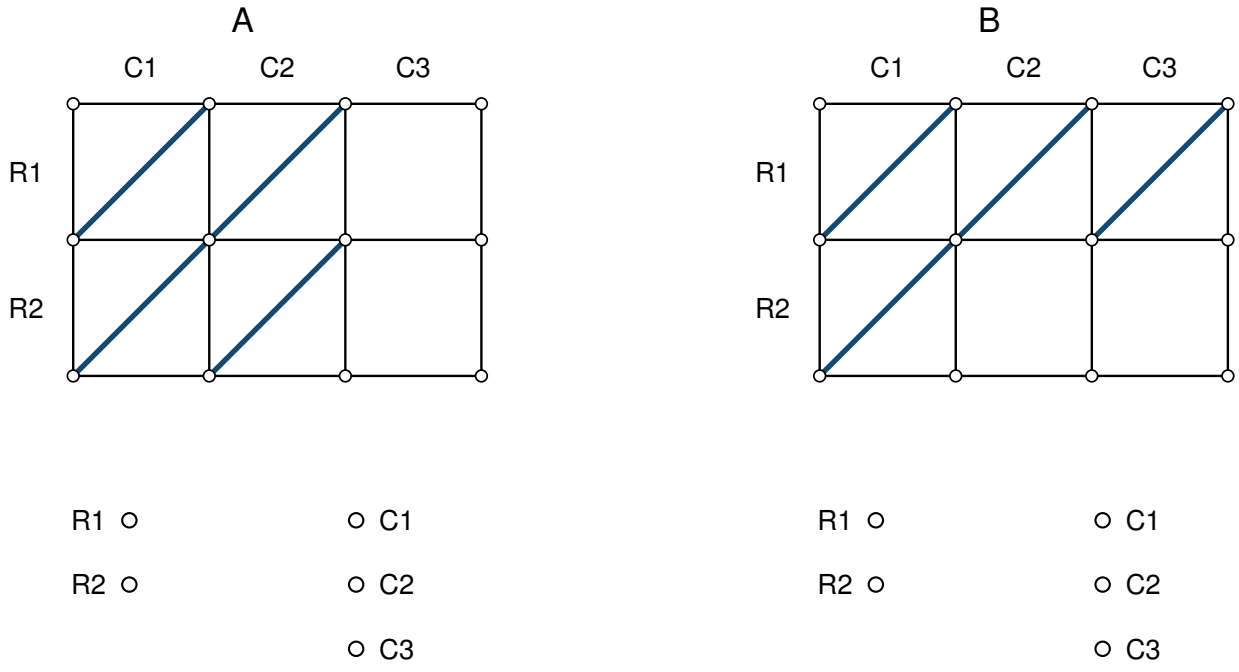




A brace becomes a link between its row dot and its column dot. Keep all the dots. Links may cross; a crossing is not a dot.

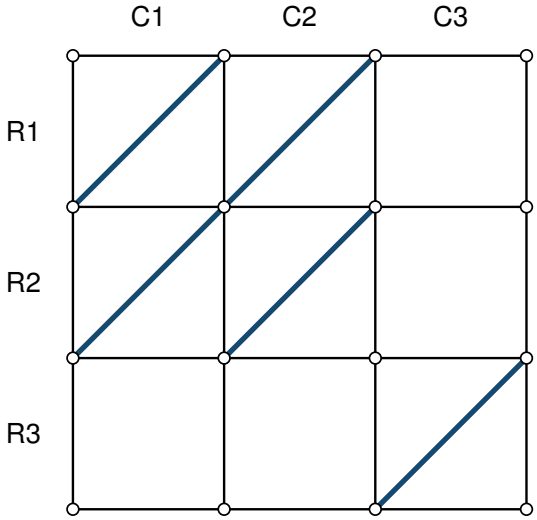


Problem 7: Make A and B on your 2-by-3 frame. Draw their links. Circle each design that holds its shape.



Problem 8: Does putting a brace in every row and every column always make a frame hold its shape? Draw A and B's links and decide.

A

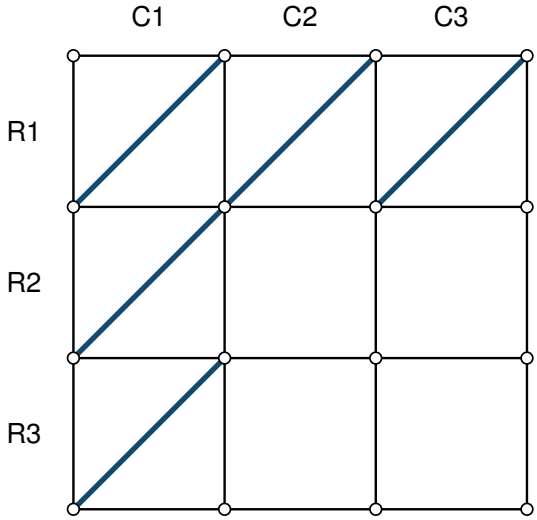


R1 ○ ○ C1

R2 ○ ○ C2

R3 ○ ○ C3

B

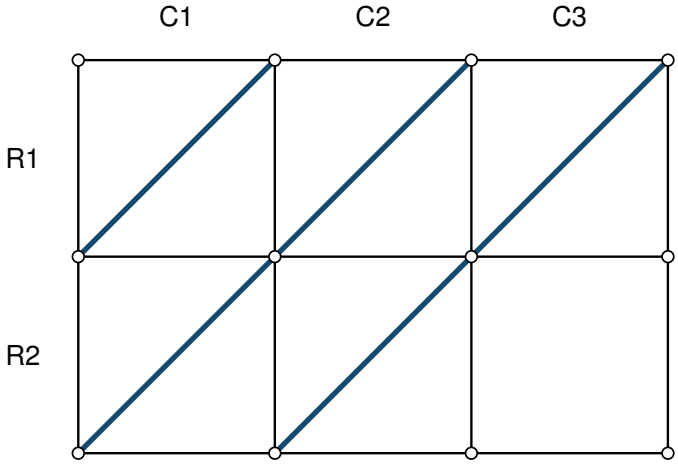


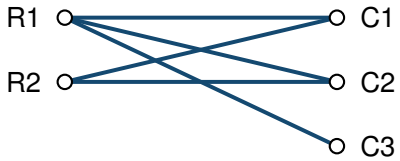
R1 ○ ○ C1

R2 ○ ○ C2

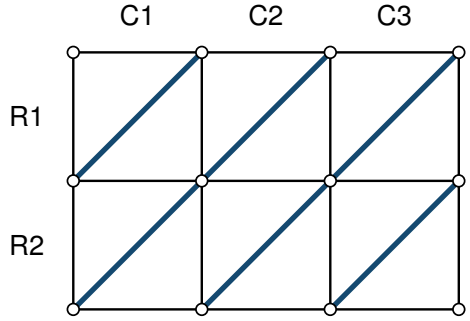
R3 ○ ○ C3

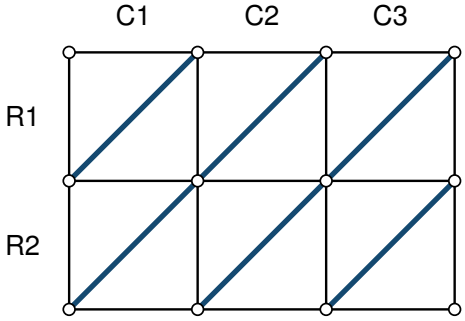
Problem 9: Find every single brace you can remove from this design while the frame still holds its shape. Replace it before testing another. Mark those braces on both pictures.

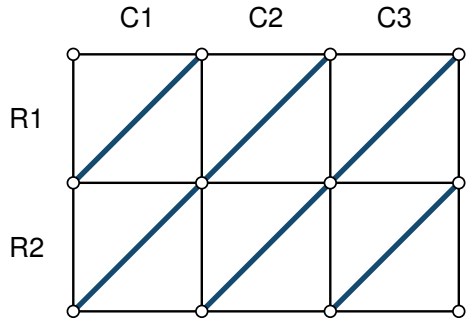


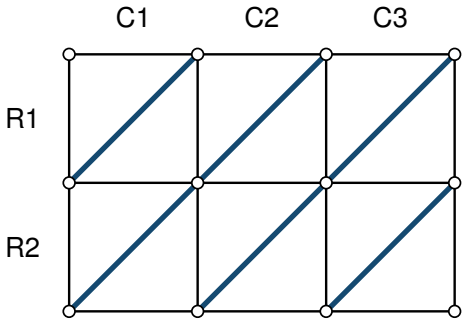


Problem 10: Starting with all six cells braced, find pairs you can remove while the frame still holds its shape, and pairs that let it change shape. Cross out the removed braces and circle each design that holds its shape.



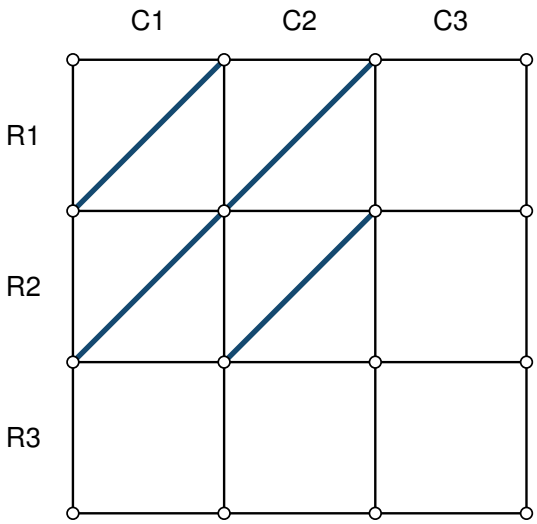






Problem 11: Can one new brace make each frame hold its shape? Mark every place that works.

A

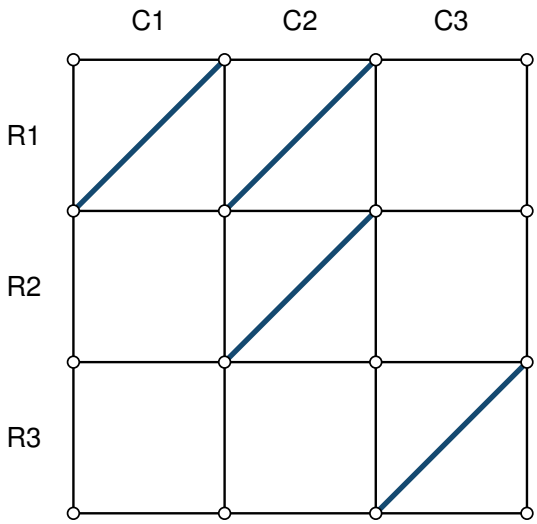


R1 ○ ○ C1

R2 ○ ○ C2

R3 ○ ○ C3

B



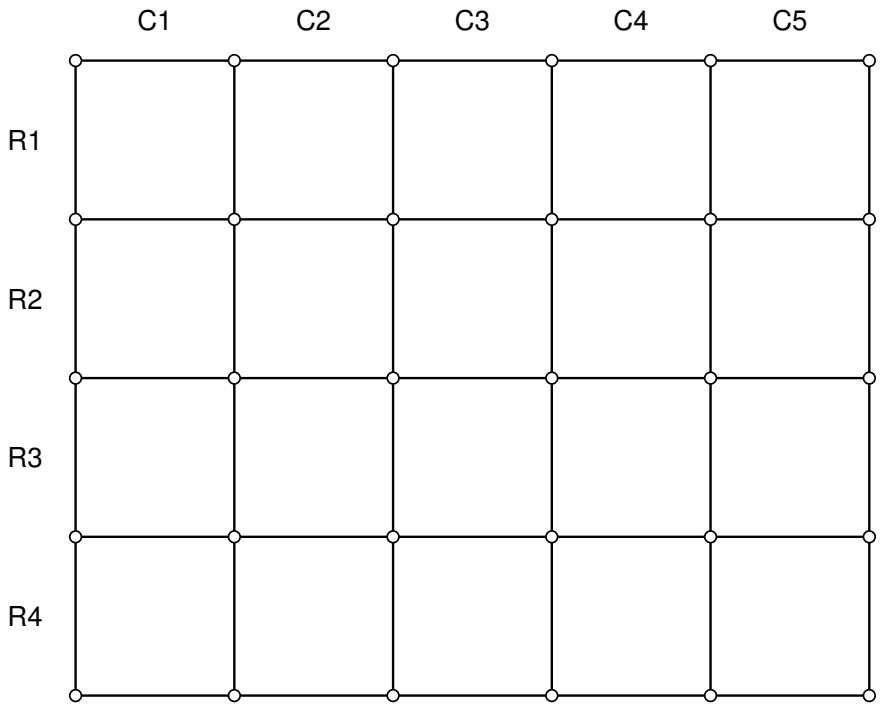
R1 ○ ○ C1

R2 ○ ○ C2

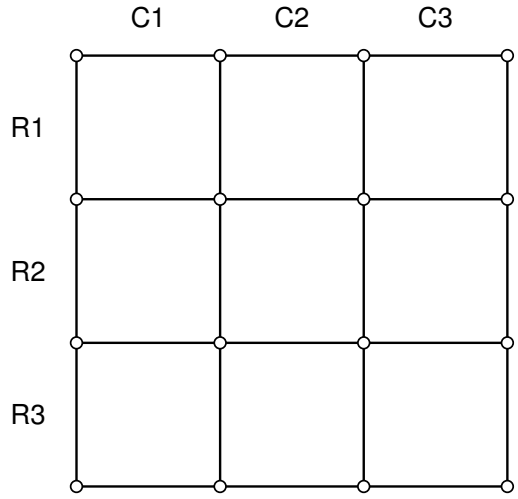
R3 ○ ○ C3

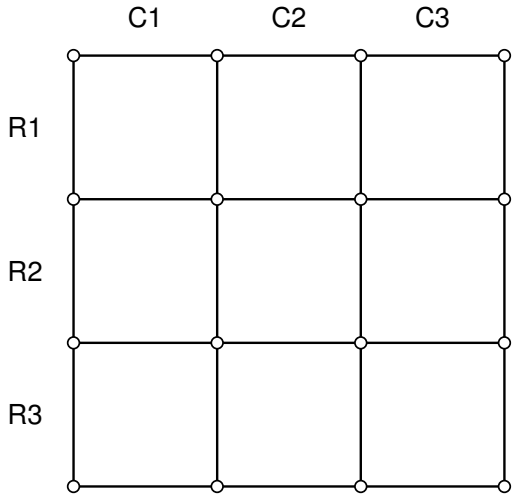
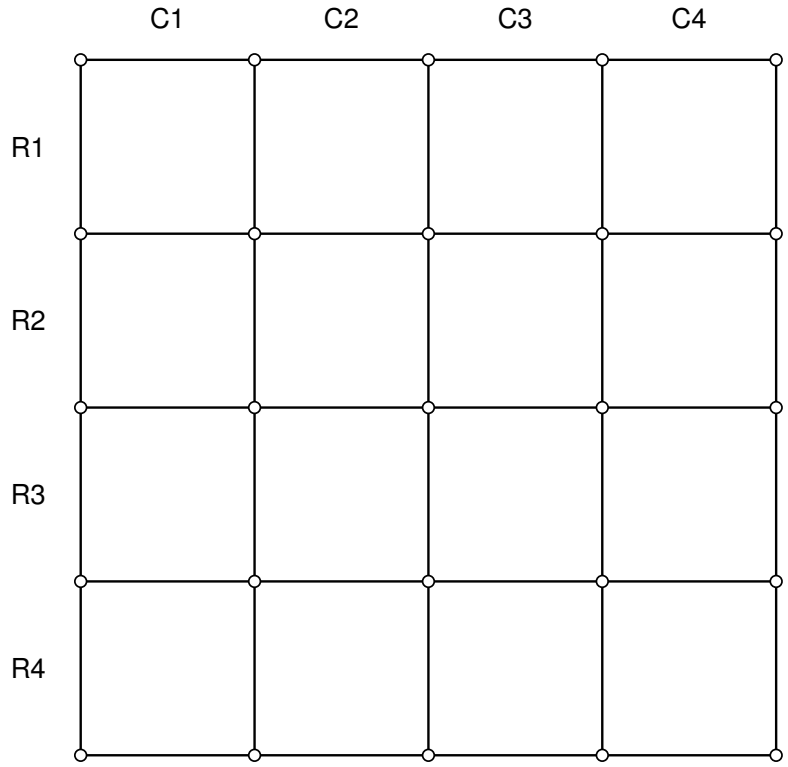
Problem 12: Find the fewest braces that make a 4-by-5 grid hold its shape. Draw a design using that many, and explain why fewer cannot work.

Fewest braces: _____



Problem 13: A 3-by-3 grid has six braces, with a brace in every row and column. Must it hold its shape? Explain.





Problem 14: A 4-by-4 grid has nine braces, with a brace in every row and column. Must it hold its shape? Explain.